Along these immense coastlines, Indians fished, used local ingredients to accompany their fruits of the sea, and created rich culinary traditions. Though not all Hindus agreed with consuming fish, many subsections of the lifestyle welcomed the use of seafood.

Konkan is a coastline along western India that stretches for 720 kilometers (nearly 450 miles) across the modern Indian states of Maharashtra, Goa, and Karnataka. Here, the Malvani people have subsisted on fish curries and rice for hundreds of years. Important dishes along the Konkan include fluffy, fried wheat and millet bread, coconut soup, mutton and chicken curries, fried duck, spicy cashews, and an assortment of seafood. Here, it is common to be served fried mackerel, curried pomfret fish, and curried or fried prawns. Coconut features heavily throughout local recipes, as does the plentiful mango of the region. The large city of Mumbai, historically a part of the Konkan though now politically separate, is home to a range of coastal delicacies that delight the senses.

Also known as Bombay, Mumbai has been packed with various flavors, fish, migrant foods, and street vendors for as long as its inhabitants have been hungry. Where once there was fresh fish, now there are complex vegetarian dishes comprised of chickpea-flour noodles, boiled potatoes, fresh tomato, cilantro (Bombay bhelpuri), exceedingly buttery breads, Persian brun maska, chai tea, and even delicacies like idli dumplings, traditionally found only in the south. There is perhaps no better place to experience the mixture of cultures, religions, and regional ingredients of ancient and modern coast India than here in one of its oldest cities.

South India is famous for a culinary tradition that includes some of the hottest, spiciest dishes in the country, though the chili pepper only arrived on the subcontinent in the mid-16th century. Indigenous to Mesoamerica, these spicy and flavorful little jewels probably came to the southwest coast of India first in the ships of Portuguese traders. In addition to a range of hot and milder curries, southern cuisine features a delicious collection of side dishes, including papadams (large, chickpea-flour crackers), crepe-like dosa breads, fried rice, and fermented lentil cakes (idlis). It is here that you will find a marked difference in the textures of each curry, as most are split between dry presentation (poriyals, served with rice) and watery stews called sambars, rasams, and kootus. Tamarind is a regular ingredient in many of these south Indian recipes, lending a sour and fruity flavor to vegetable and meat plates.